

Exclusive breastfeeding lower in India's slums: study 💎

Counter intuitively, early breastfeeding was much higher in slums compared to urban non-slum neighbourhoods, the study found

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Breastfeeding practices are, on the whole, “suboptimal” in both urban slum and urban non-slum areas in India and need to be “urgently addressed”, the paper states. Image used for representational purposes only | Photo Credit: Getty Images

Exclusive breastfeeding for the first six months, fundamental to the health and development of children, is lower in India's urban slums (50.1%) - where 65.49 million people in the country live - than in urban non-slum areas (55.8%), finds [a study](#).

“Exclusive breastfeeding [without water or other food] helps prevent diarrhoea and infections, supports intellectual and motor development, and reduces the risk of chronic diseases,” says the paper published in the journal *PLOS One*, calling for urgent intervention.

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